

ARCHITECTURAL / 2024 / EVANSTON, IL

Litowitz Family Office

1616 Orrington, Evanston



Dark patinated, bronze finished steel and reeded glass partitions, shelving, and doors across a family office floor, built and installed with union crews.

THE WORK

A sixth floor build out for the Litowitz Family Office at 1616 Orrington in Evanston: demountable steel and glass partitions, boardroom and elevator entry assemblies, library and lounge metalwork, back bar and column shelving, and custom doors, all in one dark bronze steel and reeded glass language from the elevator lobby through the boardrooms to the lounge. The direction came from the client and Gensler together, with the Gensler team, as so often, the creative engine behind it.

THE MATERIAL QUESTION

Reeded glass is extremely difficult to work with. Every piece was valuable, and one wrong measurement meant a lot of work to make a replacement. The doors were big and heavy enough to demand acute attention to detail. And this was never one wall: it was a system for hanging and mounting walls, which had to land on the millwork, the soffits, and the building's pipes without a misaligned line.

THE MAKING

We surveyed the existing conditions precisely enough that no shim or leveling gap ever had to be too wide, coordinated hardware with custom built doors, and developed methods for the curtain wall mullions and for installing them safely. Where a pipe could not move we removed a vertical mullion, and we extended a soffit to keep the geometry symmetrical from the lobby through the lounge. The steel was patinated dark, then given a bronze finish, a finish that grew out of our cast metal walls. We fabricated the system and directed Caputo's union installers, a stunning team for most of the project.

IN PLACE

It was our largest architectural package, and we learned a great deal from it. What we are proudest of is how beautiful the room turned out. Seeing the artwork that now hangs there, in its company, we are acutely aware of how special a place it is. The patina has since opened an entirely new market for the studio: we used the same finish again on the executive floors of Chase Bank Tower in downtown Chicago.

DETAILS

Year

2024

Location

Evanston, IL

Category

Architectural

Materials

Steel patinated dark and bronze finished, reeded glass

CREDITS

Client: LFO Management / Litowitz Family Office

General contractor: Clune Construction

Design review: Gensler

Millwork: Imperial Woodworking

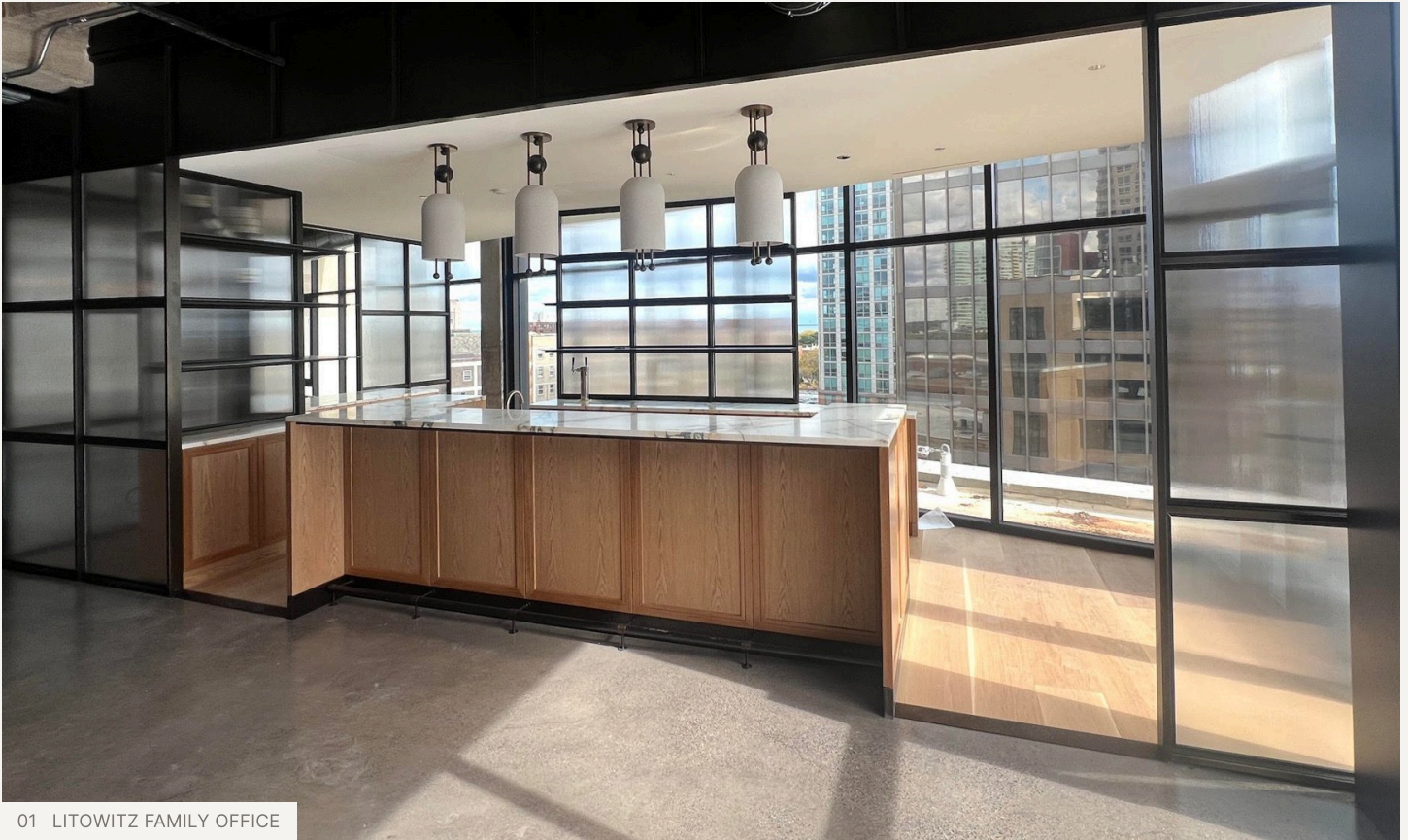
Union steel and install: Caputo Steel Erectors

STUDIO

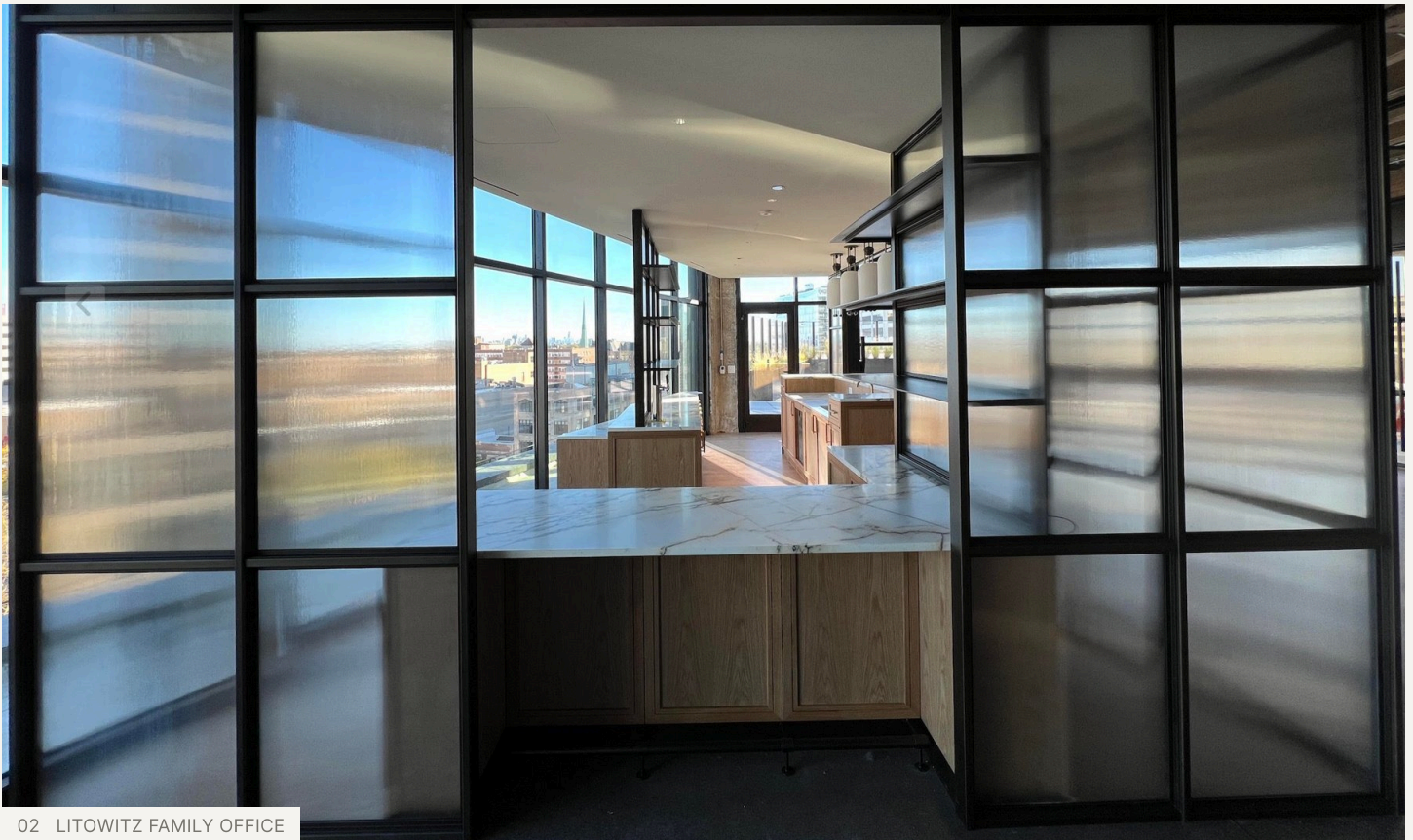
ChiLab Studio

Chicago, Illinois

Established 2013



01 LITOWITZ FAMILY OFFICE



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Bring us a drawing, a model, or a hunch.

THE STUDIO

Specialty material projects for architecture, interior design, public art, and the fine arts.

ChiLab Studio, Chicago, Illinois. Established 2013.

WHAT WE DO

Metal casting

Glass

Finishes

Digital fabrication

Metal fabrication

Restoration

Project management

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